Welcome to Nazareth

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 1 — WELCOME TO NAZARETH

PRESET

The stage is almost completely dark.

The marketplace exists in the shadows, but the audience cannot yet clearly see it.

Villagers may already be preset in place behind the darkness.

A warm special rises on NIA.

A second special reveals SIMON.

For the opening moments of the production, the entire world belongs to these two children.

CHILD STORYTELLERS

NIA
Have you ever heard of Nazareth?

SIMON
Probably not.

NIA
Simon.

SIMON
What? It’s true.

NIA
We’re not Jerusalem.

SIMON
No palace.

NIA
No great temple.

SIMON
And if Caesar ever came through here—

NIA
He was lost.

SIMON
Very lost.

They share a look.

NIA
But it’s home.

SIMON
Which means everybody knows everybody.

NIA
Who your family is.

SIMON
Where you work.

NIA
Who you’re talking to.

SIMON
Who you’re supposed to be talking to.

NIA
And if you don’t know your own business—

SIMON
Someone will explain it to you.

They grin.

NIA
Welcome to Nazareth.

LIGHT CUE — VILLAGE REVEAL

ON “NAZARETH!” THE ENTIRE STAGE BURSTS INTO WARM, VIBRANT LIGHT.

For the first time, the audience sees the full marketplace.

The village is already moving.

The light catches

merchants arranging goods;

villagers carrying baskets;

fabric opening across stalls;

workers moving crates;

bread being displayed;

children weaving through adults;

carpenters working;

women sweeping;

neighbors greeting one another;

shoppers bargaining;

jewelry being arranged;

clothing and cloth being displayed;

water being carried;

families beginning their day.

The audience should feel as though Nia and Simon have suddenly opened a window into a world that was already alive.

HAMMER.

CLAP.

STEP.

BASKET.

FABRIC SNAP.

Christian's orchestration catches the practical rhythms of the village.

MUSIC STARTS

OPENING MUSICAL HOOK

COMPANY

OHHH-OH, OOOH-OOH-OOH...

WELCOME TO NAZARETH!

COMPANY

OOOH-OOOH-OOOH...

WELCOME TO NAZARETH!

The marketplace expands into full choreography.

Nia and Simon are absorbed naturally into the village.

VERSE 1 — VILLAGE DIALOGUES

DIALOGUE 1-“EVERYBODY KNOWS YOUR BUSINESS”

**Directly establishes the theme that everybody in Nazareth knows everybody—and their business. **

The marketplace is moving rapidly. A MERCHANT sees a MAN approaching.

MERCHANT 1
Hello! Your usual?

CUSTOMER 1
Actually, today I thought—

MERCHANT 1
Your wife already came by.

CUSTOMER 1
She did?

MERCHANT 1
She said, “Don’t sell him anything we don’t need.”

CUSTOMER 1
She’s not even here.

GOSSIPER 2
She doesn’t need to be.

CUSTOMER 1
I don’t even know what I’m buying.

MERCHANT 1
We’ll tell you when we hear.

Music punches forward.

DIALOGUE 2- “NAZARETH BARGAINING”

Gives the marketplace more of a fast Broadway-comedy feeling.

A WOMAN examines an item at a merchant's stall.

WOMAN CUSTOMER 1
How much?

MERCHANT 2
Three.

WOMAN CUSTOMER 1
Two.

WOMAN CUSTOMER 1
Two—and I tell everybody you're generous.

MERCHANT 2
Three—and you tell nobody anything.

GOSSIPER 4
Too late. I heard two.

MERCHANT 2
I haven't sold it yet!

GOSSIPER 1 & 2
Give us a minute!

Everyone moves.

MERCHANT 2
I need a different village.

WOMAN CUSTOMER 1
They'd hear about you there too.

CHORUS 1

COMPANY

[WELCOME TO NAZARETH — CHORUS]

The marketplace opens wider.

The choreography celebrates the life of the village

basket exchanges becoming partner turns;

fabric moving overhead;

children weaving through formations;

merchants shifting stalls;

couples turning through the marketplace;

rhythmic clapping;

sweeping diagonals;

groups forming and reforming;

everyday work becoming dance.

The movement should feel as though Nazareth itself creates the rhythm.

VERSE 2 — MARY AND HER FRIENDS

MARY enters with SHIRA, TALIA, ADINA and DAFNA.

They are working among fabrics, garments, jewelry and marketplace goods.

The music continues underneath their dialogue.

ADINA
Mary, we're late.

MARY
We are not late.

TALIA
We are if someone is waiting for us.

DAFNA
Someone is waiting for Mary.

MARY
Dafna.

DAFNA
I didn't say who.

TALIA
You didn't need to.

SHIRA
Can we discuss Mary's future while walking?

DAFNA
Absolutely.

MARY
Can we not discuss Mary's future at all?

SHIRA
You keep looking for him.

MARY
I'm not looking for anyone.

Talia catches Mary glancing across the marketplace.

TALIA
That is clearly untrue.

DAFNA
Joseph.

MARY
I know who she means.

DAFNA
Then we're all caught up.

Mary laughs.

ADINA
Good. Now move.

DAFNA
You see how she speaks to us?

MARY
Move, Dafna.

DAFNA
Now there are two of them.

The women laugh and are swept back into the choreography.

MUSICAL TRANSITION INTO VERSE 2

A carpentry rhythm emerges.

HAMMER.

HAMMER.

WOOD.

CLAP.

STEP.

VERSE 2 (con.) — JOSEPH AND HIS FRIENDS

A carpentry rhythm emerges: HAMMER. HAMMER. WOOD. CLAP. STEP. JOSEPH enters with LEVI, MALACHI, CALEB and EZRA.

JOSEPH
Caleb.

CALEB
Don’t say it.

JOSEPH
It’s crooked.

CALEB
It’s artistic.

EZRA
It is crooked artistically.

LEVI
Give it here.

CALEB
Why does everyone assume I need help?

The piece slips. Levi catches it.

LEVI
Instinct.

MALACHI
Experience.

EZRA
Evidence.

CALEB
Joseph, defend me.

JOSEPH
It still holds. That is not the same as being right.

CALEB
I withdraw my request.

The men laugh.

LEVI
Enjoy this while you can.

JOSEPH
Enjoy what?

CALEB
Freedom.

JOSEPH
I’m getting married. I’m not being arrested.

EZRA
There are similarities in the paperwork.

MALACHI
Ezra.

EZRA
I said paperwork.

Laugh.

LEVI
Does Mary know how much time you spend talking to wood?

JOSEPH
The wood listens better than all of you.

CALEB
Then marry the wood.

JOSEPH
I’m reconsidering my friendships.

The men pull Joseph back into the musical rhythm.

CHORUS 2

COMPANY

[WELCOME TO NAZARETH — CHORUS]

NO SPOKEN DIALOGUE.

The stage divides into three simultaneous worlds.

DOWNSTAGE LEFT — JOSEPH AND HIS FRIENDS

Joseph remains with

Levi

Malachi

Caleb

Ezra

They continue working with carpentry materials.

Their work stays connected rhythmically to the music

measuring;

sanding;

carrying wood;

hammering;

checking angles;

passing tools;

repositioning benches or work pieces.

Joseph remains visibly skilled.

His friends interact physically and comedically without speaking.

DOWNSTAGE RIGHT — MARY AND HER FRIENDS

Mary remains with

Shira

Talia

Adina

Dafna

They continue working with

fabrics;

jewelry;

clothing;

thread;

cloth;

baskets;

decorative goods.

Their work may become choreographed through

folding;

passing fabric;

measuring;

fastening jewelry;

displaying garments;

stretching cloth;

turning one another;

carrying goods through formations.

CENTER STAGE — VILLAGE DANCERS

The village dancers own the center of the stage.

The featured choreography becomes the visual focus.

Use

traveling movement;

turns;

partner work;

marketplace-inspired choreography;

rhythmic prop work;

villagers crossing through moving dance formations.

MARY AND JOSEPH — SILENT CONNECTION

The chorus reaches a musical punctuation. The orchestration reduces rather than implying anything supernatural. Ordinary village life shifts into extreme slow motion. Mary and Joseph remain at normal speed. Villagers continue bargaining, working, carrying, reaching and crossing around them. For a moment, the audience experiences the town through Mary and Joseph.

Mary crosses with a handmade TOOL SATCHEL.

MARY

I made this for you. A new tool satchel.

JOSEPH
For me?

MARY
Yours was falling apart.

JOSEPH
I was calling it well-loved.

MARY
Then cherish this one instead.

JOSEPH
I will. Especially because you made it.

Mary smiles. Their hands may briefly meet naturally during the exchange, but the touch is not treated as a magical cue. Joseph puts the satchel over his shoulder. They remain together one beat longer than necessary.

Mary begins walking away. Joseph watches her one beat too long.

MUSIC / MOVEMENT SNAP

BANG. Full tempo, sound and marketplace movement return at once. Joseph is a fraction late returning to the world; a passing villager or carried object may nearly catch him unaware.

CALEB
You coming?

JOSEPH
I’m coming.

He is still looking toward Mary.

CALEB
Joseph.

JOSEPH
I said I’m coming.

The musical number surges forward.

MUSIC SLAMS BACK IN

The village explodes out of the freeze.

Mary rejoins her friends downstage right.

Joseph rejoins his friends downstage left.

Joseph now visibly carries the satchel Mary made for him.

The choreography becomes increasingly energetic.

INSTRUMENTAL BUILD

The marketplace starts transforming into larger dance vocabulary.

Props may include

baskets;

fabric;

stools;

crates;

staffs;

lightweight tools;

market goods.

Props should create

levels;

pathways;

rotations;

exchanges;

visual reveals;

rhythmic accents.

GOSSIP BREAK

Joseph proudly puts the new satchel over his shoulder.

GOSSIPER 1 watches them.

GOSSIPER 1
Did you see that?

GOSSIPER 2
What?

GOSSIPER 1
Mary made Joseph a new satchel.

GOSSIPER 2
She gave him new tools?

GOSSIPER 1
No. A satchel.

But Gossiper 2 is already moving away.

GOSSIPER 2
Mary bought Joseph all new tools!

GOSSIPER 3 hears only that.

GOSSIPER 3
New tools?

GOSSIPER 2
That's what I heard.

GOSSIPER 3
He must be opening his own workshop.

Gossiper 3 crosses immediately.

GOSSIPER 3
Joseph's opening a new workshop!

GOSSIPER 4
¿Aquí?

GOSSIPER 3
I don't know. Maybe Jerusalem.

Gossiper 4 GASPS.

GOSSIPER 4
¿Jerusalén? Ay, Dios mío. Mary and Joseph are moving to Jerusalem!

She immediately turns to another villager.

VILLAGER WOMAN 1
What?!

GOSSIPER 4
Right after the wedding.

VILLAGER WOMAN 1
Who told you?

GOSSIPER 4
Everybody knoooows, mi amoooor.

The gossipers hurry away. The dancers reclaim center stage. The number builds through its dance climax into the final company chorus and button.

MUSIC SLAMS BACK IN.

DANCE CLIMAX

FULL INSTRUMENTAL

This is the major dance feature of the opening number.

The dance vocabulary can include

barrel turns;

traveling turns;

jumps;

controlled flips by trained performers;

partner spins;

appropriate lifts;

floor-to-standing transitions;

rhythmic footwork;

fabric work;

basket choreography;

prop exchanges;

rotating circles;

intersecting diagonals;

athletic men's movement;

traveling turns;

children's choreographed pathways.

The choreography should build in layers.

One group gets a featured moment.

Another group answers.

Another section builds.

Then the full village joins.

It should feel like a Broadway company number—not a sequence of unrelated tricks.

MUSICAL BUILD INTO FINAL CHORUS

Christian drives the orchestration upward.

The dancers pull the full community back into the number.

Mary and her friends return.

Joseph and his friends return.

Children join.

Merchants join.

Families join.

Nia and Simon join.

The entire town fills the stage.

FINAL CHORUS

FULL COMPANY

[FINAL “WELCOME TO NAZARETH” CHORUS]

Everything established throughout the number now comes together

work

family

friendship

community

movement

celebration

Nazareth

COMPANY

OHHH-OH, OOOH-OOH-OOH...

WELCOME TO NAZARETH!

COMPANY

OOOH-OOOH-OOOH...

WELCOME TO NAZARETH!

FINAL MUSICAL BUTTON

HIT.

FINAL POSE

The company lands in multiple levels and varied positions.

Suggested visual composition

featured dancers extended;

children lower;

vendors framing the stage;

workers with tools;

fabric creating height;

Mary's group downstage right;

Joseph's group downstage left;

Nia and Simon clearly visible;

Mary and Joseph visible within their separate worlds.

The picture should communicate

THIS IS NAZARETH.

HOLD FOR APPLAUSE.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 2 — THE TOWN GOES HOME

The tableau releases into closing time, not a scene change.

Every exit has a reason. Bread is covered. Fabric is folded. Tools are gathered. Children are collected. Merchants count or pack. Families head home.

The town gradually empties around Mary and Joseph.

Nia sees Mary lingering, then Joseph. She knows exactly what is happening.

NIA
Come on.

SIMON
I didn't say anything.

NIA
You were about to.

They exit.

Mary's friends notice she is staying.

SHIRA
Tomorrow?

MARY
Tomorrow.

Shira smiles. She gathers the others and they head home.

Joseph's friends gather the last work materials.

CALEB
Joseph.

Joseph looks.

JOSEPH
Go ahead. I'll catch up.

Caleb follows Joseph's eyes toward Mary.

CALEB
Right.

EZRA
We'll see him tomorrow.

CALEB
Will we?

JOSEPH

Go.

They laugh and exit with the remaining materials.

The village continues disappearing.

One last basket.

One last hammer.

One last footstep.

Silence.

The enormous public world of Nazareth is gone.

Mary and Joseph find themselves on opposite sides of the now-empty marketplace.

For the first time tonight, nobody is between them.

Joseph still wears the satchel Mary made for him.

They look at one another.

The LED remains the same Nazareth—but the last warmth of afternoon is giving way to early evening. The bright marketplace lighting settles into something quieter and more intimate.

The earliest musical DNA of “My Beloved” begins.

Mary moves toward Joseph.

Joseph moves toward Mary.

The distance between them disappears.

END SCENE 1 / SCENE 2 CONTINUES